

Paul T. Chiou

Software Accessibility Researcher & Digital Accessibility Program Lead

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SUMMARY

Experienced digital accessibility researcher, software engineer, and higher-education accessibility practitioner with 7+ years of expertise in enhancing web, mobile, and digital services accessibility. Currently the Digital Accessibility SME at UC Irvine Libraries, leading ADA Title II and WCAG 2.1 AA compliance for web properties, digital assets, vendor tools, and communication media. Proficient in translating accessibility requirements into workable solutions using QA, issue triage, risk tracking, staff training, and AI-assisted prototypes. Holds a Ph.D. in Computer Science from USC with NSF-funded research, top-tier publications in software engineering and HCI, and a U.S. patent for detecting keyboard accessibility barriers. Merges research, technical skills, leadership, and personal experience with assistive tech to foster inclusive digital systems.

EXPERIENCE

Digital Communications Specialist 3 / Digital Accessibility SME

09/2025 - Present | Irvine, California

UC Irvine Libraries

- Lead ADA Title II accessibility strategy across library websites, digital assets, vendor tools, videos, PDFs, email templates, and the website redesign project.
- Coordinate monitoring for 29 web properties and advise Library IT developers on technical remediation, helping resolve Siteimprove issues and raise the accessibility score from 90.5 to 95.6.
- Manage accessibility risk tracking for 295 vendor products and 483 digital assets, including VPAT/ACR review, PDF remediation cost/feasibility analysis, and remediation prioritization.
- Developed AI-assisted accessibility prototype apps for scalable VPAT/ACR review and PDF-to-HTML document delivery within library workflows.
- Led staff accessibility enablement and GAAD programming for 130 library staff, including training and edit-a-thon activities.

Research Assistant, Software Accessibility

08/2018 - 06/2026 | Los Angeles, California

University of Southern California

- Led accessibility research direction in web and Android accessibility, including keyboard navigation, dialogs, reflow, UI touch-target and text scaling, and TalkBack failures.
- Helped secure a \$495K NSF grant through proposal writing; managed and co-managed accessibility research projects that produced nine top-tier software engineering/HCI publications and a U.S. patent, [US12229390B2](https://patents.google.com/patent/US12229390B2).
- Mentored junior and peer Ph.D. students on accessibility research design, technical direction, and evaluation methods, resulting in the development of three first-author papers.
- Tested 1,000+ real-world web and Android applications and collaborated with 30+ people with motor and vision disabilities to understand and improve assistive technology user experience.

Teaching Assistant / Guest Lecturer

08/2018 - 04/2026 | Los Angeles, California

University of Southern California

- Integrated WCAG, inclusive design, and accessibility QA into software engineering instruction for 300+ undergraduate students through lectures, interactive in-class hands-on activities, exams, and grading rubrics.

SELECTED RESEARCH, RECOGNITION & SERVICE

Selected Research and Service

- Published accessibility research in CHI 2023, ICSE 2023/2024; ESEC/FSE 2021; ICST 2022/2026; and ICSME 2023/2026, including a CHI 2023 Honorable Mention.
- Reviewer/Program Committee service on web/mobile accessibility for ASSETS, CHI, TSE, IJHCI, and Assistive Technology.
- Recognition includes the Google Lime Scholarship, ARCS Scholar, USC Viterbi Jenny Wang Excellence in Teaching Award, and CSU Trustees' Award.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Ph.D., Computer Science

06/2018 - 12/2025 | Los Angeles, California

University of Southern California

Dissertation: Automated Detection of Keyboard Accessibility Issues in Web Applications

B.S., M.S. Computer Science

01/2015 - 06/2018 | Pomona, California

California State Polytechnic University, Pomona

Certifications

IAAP Certified Professional in Accessibility Core Competencies (CPACC), DHS Section 508 Trusted Tester